

Chapter 55-2: 冒犯 (Offense)

The sky had already grown quite dark. There were no lamps lit in the room, and Chu Qingqiu's body was already shrouded in shadow. She sat with closed eyes for a while, then suddenly reached out toward Ning Fuyi, her pale fingers slightly curved, fingertips flushed red.

"Ning Fuyi, I'm a bit tired," she said.

These words were spoken with fatigue, but they also carried a lively human quality. Ning Fuyi couldn't help but feel flustered. She stepped forward and offered the back of her hand to her. Seeing that she seemed unable to grasp it steadily, she turned her hand around to completely hold her soft palm and helped her up.

Ning Fuyi suddenly realized that Chu Qingqiu no longer seemed to refer to herself as "this venerable one."¹

The woman's fragrant hair brushed past her nose. Her mature body was warm, with delicate bones but soft flesh. Ning Fuyi bit her lip as she helped her to the bed, lifted the bedding, and watched the woman lie down flat.

Once she lay down, she didn't say another word, as if she had already fallen asleep. Ning Fuyi habitually arranged the blanket properly. When she stood up, her gaze fell on those lips.

They were a bit pale and dry, bearing a sickly appearance that made one want to offensively moisten them.

By the time Ning Fuyi came to her senses, she was already leaning down, her cheek no more than half an arm's length from Chu Qingqiu's lips. She cursed something under her breath and hurriedly straightened up.

Ning Fuyi, have you gone mad? This is Chu Qingqiu! Even if you don't hate her anymore, she's still the Divine Venerable!

She didn't dare linger any longer. Turning around, she quickly left, almost fleeing in panic. With a creak, she closed the door, and the room fell into silence.

The person who had been motionless on the bed suddenly opened her eyes. Her peach-blossom-like pupils stared straight at the dark ceiling. Her fingertips covered her lips, gently caressing them with lingering motions, as if savoring something.

Then she sighed and closed her eyes, a crystal tear falling from the corner of her eye.

Footnotes:

1. **本尊 (This Venerable One)** - A formal, distant way of referring to oneself used by high-ranking cultivators and deities. Chu Qingqiu's shift away from this formal self-address suggests she's becoming less formal and distant with Ning Fuyi.

